

The clear zone commences from the closest edge of the through travelled way for the direction of travel and is the total roadside border area available for safe use by errant vehicles. This clear zone area may consist of a shoulder, a verge, and a recoverable slope.

While the clear zone concept draws on a wide range of experience and research, engineering judgement should also be applied in the determination of lateral position requirements. The guidance here should be regarded as a supplement to aid in exercising this judgement and not as a substitute for it.

Roadside hazards should be located outside the clear zone or be protected by a suitable and approved safety barrier. If a safety barrier is installed no portion of the hazard is to be located within the deflection limits of the safety barrier.

Hazards that lie outside the clear zone will generally not require assessment because the locations are a sufficient distance from the edge of the road that the probability of a collision is relatively small.

6.11.1 Factors influencing the clear zone

New

The variables that influence the determination of the clear zone include:

- traffic volumes
- vehicle speeds
- road curvature (geometry)
- roadside slopes (cut and fill), and
- presence of physical devices that limit or prevent errant vehicle incursion (e.g. safety barrier or steep cutting).

It is important to consider both objects (hazards) and terrain that may cause vehicles to rollover.

6.11.2 Determination of clear zone requirements

New

The influence of the above-mentioned variables on the width of the clear zone is determined by assessing the roadside environment in accordance with the following:

- The clear zone is measured by extending a horizontal plane from the edge of the travelled way to the edge of the hazard, as indicated in Figure 6.11.2(a).